PRAY OSAKA LOOP

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天王寺
Tennōji

Tennoji is home to Abeno Harukas, one of the tallest buildings in Japan. Shitennoji Temple is also located nearby, known for the bells which are rung throughout the temple grounds. Numbered tickets are often given for entry due to the crowds.

Mark 4:19-20
But the cares of the world and the deceitfulness of riches and the desires for other things enter in and choke the word, and it proves unfruitful. But those that were sown on the good soil are the ones who hear the word and accept it and bear fruit.

Departure Melody
🎶 Are You to Ring that Bell 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Among all of the aesthetically pleasing buildings and urban shine, pray that the seeds of the Gospel would not get choked out by the thorns of life.
2. Pray that the truth of the Bible would be something all Japanese people long to hear and learn about.
3. Ask that the churches near Tennoji would be faithful to sow the seeds of the Gospel in truth and love.

寺田町
Teradachō

Teradacho is often used to avoid the larger crowds at Tennoji station. Teradacho used to be the last station on this train line, before the line was bought and merged with other lines to form the Osaka Loop.

Ephesians 3:17-18
So that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith—that you, being rooted and grounded in love, may have strength to comprehend with all the saints what is the breadth and length and height and depth, and to know the love of Christ that surpasses knowledge.

Departure Melody
♪♪ Life Goes On ♪♪

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that the "loop" of Buddhism or Shinto would be cut, and a new "line" in Japan would rise up as bold Christians within their families and culture.
2. Many Japanese believers feel that reaching their fellow Japanese with the gospel is too difficult, even impossible. Pray that they would trust in God's plan and be faithful in sharing the gospel.

桃谷
Momodani

Momodani's neighborhood strongly retains the charming Osaka scenery of olden days. Home to coffeehouses, penny candy shops and used book stores, this neighborhood has an atmosphere of warmth and community.

1 Corinthians 12:12
For just as the body is one and has many members, and all the members of the body, though many, are one body, so it is with Christ.

Departure Melody
🎶 Sake, Tears, Men & Women 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray for warmth and a sense of community to be found in existing Japanese churches.
2. Pray for the truth of God's Word to inspire healthy cultural changes within the old traditions of Japan.
3. Pray for Believers both Japanese and missionaries as they work to show the love of Jesus to others.

鶴橋
Tsuruhashi

Tsuruhashi is the center of Osaka's Korea Town, well-known for its many Korean restaurants and shops. The aroma of delicious food can be enjoyed even from inside the station. This area, though not too far from Japan's largest "slum," is a reflection of a different era.

2 Corinthians 2:14-16
Through us spreads the fragrance of the knowledge of him everywhere. For we are the aroma of Christ to God among those who are being saved and among those who are perishing, to one a fragrance from death to death, to the other a fragrance from life to life.

Departure Melody
🎶 All You Can Eat Yodel 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that the Gospel will be pleasant and appealing to all those who hear.
2. Pray that as Jesus is shared, the Holy Spirit would work in the hearts and minds of the Japanese to feel His peace and hope.
3. Pray for a sweet fragrance of salvation and worship from the Japanese to rise up to God rather than incense and idolatry.

玉造
Tamatsukuri

"Tamatsukuri" literally means "jewelry making," as this area was a center for making talismans in ancient times. These talismans were made of jade and quartz and were used for good fortune and protection from evil. At a nearby shrine, some of these talismans are still on display.

Psalm 115:4,8
Their idols are silver and gold, the work of human hands. ... Those who make them become like them; so do all who trust in them.

Departure Melody
🎶 Mary Had a Little Lamb 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray the Japanese would see the emptiness of their idol worship and turn to the one true God.
2. Pray the children in Japan would have early exposure to the gospel, leading to waves of new believers.

森ノ宮
Morinomiya

This station is one of two that provide access to Osaka Castle Park. This half of the park is home to a large, majestic fountain, as well as a small World War II museam. Adjacent to the station is a shopping mall that boasts a jogging track in the sky.

John 7:36-38
Jesus stood up and cried out, "If anyone thirsts, let him come to me and drink. Whoever believes in me, as the scripture has said, 'Out of his heart will flow rivers of living water.'"

Departure Melody
🎶 Bear of the Forest 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. As the Japanese search for rest and a place of relaxation in the midst of the city, pray that they would seek Jesus for their true rest and "living water".
2. Pray that Japanese churches would become the front runners of the mission task in Japan.

大阪城公園
Ōsakajōkōen

Ōsakajōkōen ("Osaka Castle Park") is one of two stations that provide access to the famous Osaka Castle. In the spring, the Castle becomes one of Osaka's most crowded cherry blossom viewing sites. It has been rebuilt many times, most recently in 1931, with the interior now functioning as a modern museum.

Psalm 18:2
The Lord is my rock and my fortress and my deliverer, my God, my rock, in whom I take refuge, my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my stronghold.

Departure Melody
🎶 Conch 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that the Japanese would look to Jesus as their fortress and deliverer.
2. Pray that beauty of Jesus' face would become more famous in Japan than even the cherry blossoms.

京橋
Kyōbashi

Kyōbashi is one of the city's transportation hubs and entertainment districts, mostly catering to Japanese salarymen rather than tourists. Its streets are lined with restaurants, bars and pachinko parlors. Inebriated businessmen can be seen stumbling home at all hours of the morning.

2 Corinthians 4:4
In their case the god of this world has blinded the minds of the unbelievers, to keep them from seeing the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ, who is the image of God.

Departure Melody
🎶 Old McDonald 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. For the salarymen who drown their sadness with alcohol and pachinko: Pray that they would taste and see that the Lord is good.
2. For the owners of the bars and restaurants: Pray that they would come to Christ and be lights in their community.

桜ノ宮
Sakuranomiya

Sakuranomiya literally translates as "Cherry Blossom Palace." The park near the station boasts beautiful cherry blossom trees and is a popular spot for picnickers, runners, and those who enjoy nature.

Acts 26:18
So that they may turn from darkness to light and from the power of satan to God, that they may receive forgiveness of sins and a place among those who are sanctified by faith in me.

Departure Melody
♪♪ Sakura ♪♪

Prayer Requests

1. Ask God to use the beauty in nature to reveal Himself to those in Japan.
2. Pray that God's love would be shown to the homeless, elderly and poor who live near this area.
3. Pray that Sakuranomiya park could be used in outreach and ministry to reach many Japanese with the Gospel.

天満
Tenma

The Tenma area is home to the longest shopping street in Japan, over 1.5 miles. This area began to flourish due to the nearby Shinto shrine where people came to worship the god of studies. A festival is held each July with fireworks and parades along the street and river.

Ephesians 2:12-13
Remember that you were at that time separated from Christ, ... having no hope and without God in the world. But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ.

Departure Melody
🎶 Fireworks 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray the Japanese would see that materialism and wealth cannot fill the God-shaped void in their lives.
2. There are many vacant buildings throughout the shopping street. Ask that God would prepare a place for a church plant.
3. Pray that the festival near Tenma would be used as an opportunity to share Christ rather than idolatrous worship.

大阪
Ōsaka

Osaka Station is largest station in the city, housing a total of 5 train lines not to mention the subway lines. Over 500,000 people pass through the station each day.

Matthew 9:37-38
Then he said, "The harvest is plentiful, but the laborers are few; therefore pray earnestly to the Lord of the harvest to send out laborers into his harvest."

Departure Melody
🎶 I Really Like it Here 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray for more missionaries, national pastors and regular Christians to surrender and be obedient to the call of reaching the Japanese.
2. Ask that God would bring a great harvest to Japan.

福島
Fukushima

Fukushima boasts streets upon streets full of quaint restaurants, providing a much quieter alternative to the bustling city center nearby. This area is a mix of old and new; alleyways packed with tiny, traditional restaurants are nestled right next to modern apartments and cafes.

Isaiah 43:19
Behold, I am doing a new thing; now it springs forth, do you not perceive it? I will make a way in the wilderness and rivers in the desert.

Departure Melody
🎶 Dream Flower 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that as gospel conversations are had over meals, the Holy Spirit would open eyes and ears to receive.
2. Pray for Japanese believers who gather and eat, that they would be iron sharpening iron.

野田
Noda

The majority of Osaka's food supply comes through Noda's Central Wholesale Market. Each morning at 4:15am, the market holds a special auction for the freshest tuna. Unlike most retail businesses, Osaka's Central market is closed on Sundays.

Mark 8:35-36
For whoever would save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for my sake and the gospel's will save it. For what does it profit a man to gain the whole world and forfeit his soul?

Departure Melody
🎶 Russian Folk Song 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray for businesses to be more flexible concerning their working hours so that their employees can attend church.
2. Just as Jesus used fish and food to reach many, ask that He would use the area of Noda and God's creation to reach many for His Kingdom.

西九条
Nishikujō

Nishi-Kujo is the nearest station to the Japan Rail West training facility, employing over 47,000 Japanese. Many also transfer here for the popular theme park, Universal Studios Japan.

Psalm 139:14-15
I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well. My frame was not hidden from you, when I was being made in secret, intricately woven in the depths of the earth.

Departure Melody
🎶 American Patrol 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Intercede for the Japanese as they use amusement and other sources of "fun" to numb the pain in their lives.
2. Pray for the Gospel to work among the train drivers, mechanics, security and crews. Pray for their safety.
3. Ask that God would rescue His creations, fearfully and wonderfully made, who are contemplating suicide, specifically involving Japan's railways.

弁天町
Bentenchō

The smallest of the stations along the loop line, Bentenchō serves a quiet area and provides a transfer to the Chuo Subway Line. Small as it is, still over 80,000 people live in this ward of the city, most of whom know nothing about the gospel.

Micah 5:2
But you, O Bethlehem Ephrathah, who are too little to be among the clans of Judah, from you shall come forth for me one who is to be ruler in Israel, whose coming forth is from of old, from ancient days.

Departure Melody
♪♪ I've been workin' on the railroad ♪♪

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that God would raise up a strong Christian leader out of the quiet streets of Bentenchō.
2. Pray that Christians would encounter "persons of peace" who are open to talk about the Gospel.

大正
Taishō

The Taisho area is named after the former Taisho Emperor and the era in which Japan became a democratic society. The Osaka Dome, home to Orix Buffalo baseball team, is also located here.

John 10:10
The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I came that they may have life and have it abundantly.

Departure Melody
🎶 Okinawa Folk Song 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray for the Gospel to be shared and churches to be planted among the Japanese who are from Okinawa.
2. Ask that God would bring salvation to Japan so greatly that the Osaka Dome could be filled with thousands worshipping His name.
3. Historically, Japan has been attracted to western culture. Pray that they would be taken by the idea of a relationship with God and desire abundant life in Him.

芦原橋
Ashiharabashi

Ashiharabashi is known for its famous landmarks in nearby Namba but also for many long established drum makers. These drums have a long tradition of being used to worship the many false gods of Japan.

Psalm 150:5-6
Praise him with sounding cymbals; praise him with loud clashing cymbals! Let everything that has breath praise the Lord! Praise the Lord!

Departure Melody
🎶 Festival 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray that Japanese churches would have an evangelistic heart for their own nation and for those who come as tourists to Osaka.
2. Ask that God would break the strongholds of Buddhism and Shinto and that the festivals could be used for His purposes.
3. Pray that the sound of drums in Japan will one day be used to praise the risen Lord.

今宮
Imamiya

Shinto, the native religion of Japan, considers anything related to death as unclean and repugnant. Since the people of Imamiya, "leather city" were known for crafting leather goods, they also were considered lowly and unclean.

1 John 1:9
If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Departure Melody
🎶 God of Great Darkness and Fortune 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Ask the one true living God to show the Japanese that they can be made clean through His son Jesus.
2. While a classed based society no longer exists in Japan, many still are trapped in the cycles of poverty & hopelessness. Pray for all Japanese to be set free by the liberty found only in Jesus.
3. Pray that Japanese people would realize the lack of power of the "gods" as they pray and visit shrines and would search something greater.

新今宮
Shin-Imamiya

This area is sadly "home" to many homeless, outcasts and victims of overwhelming cultural pressures. Each year, the nearby Ebisu Shrine hosts a festival in which Osaka business owners pray to the gods of commerce and prosperity.

John 6:51
I am the living bread that came down from heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever.

Departure Melody
🎶 New World 🎶

Prayer Requests

1. Pray for the homeless, hungry and outcast of Japan to be satisifed through the living bread of Christ.
2. Pray that God would cultivate a "new world" in the culture of Japan defined by His grace and love rather than society's expectations.
3. Ask that Japanese Christians would become more willing to reach out to those on the outskirts to share the love of Christ.